

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI): Final offer for GEH to resolve prolonged acquisition overhang, next step still key

Today (6th Jun), OCBC and GEH (Great Eastern Holdings, not covered) released a joint announcement to resolve the trading suspension of GEH, which has ceased to meet free float requirements following close of the voluntary unconditional general offer by OCBC launched on 10th May 2024. An EGM will be convened to vote on 1) **delisting of GEH** accompanied by a **conditional exit offer of S\$30.15 per share**, 17.8% higher than the last GO price in May 2024, **or 2) resumption of GEH trading** if the delisting is not approved. The exit offer letter will be despatched on 9th Jun 2025, and be valid until at least 21 days after despatch, or 14 days after the EGM, while the EGM date is not yet specified.

OCBC stated it has no intention to revise the offer price, and no intention of making another offer in the foreseeable future if GEH resumes trading. As such, this marks progress in terms of removing the overhang regarding potential upward adjustments to acquisition costs and providing more clarity to the market, which is supportive of OCBC's share price. By our estimate, acquiring the remaining 6.3% in GEH would cost S\$896mn (S\$135mn more than the previous offer price for the remaining shares) and lower OCBC excess capital as of 1Q25 to S\$583mn, excluding the committed S\$2.5bn capital return plans.

For a further re-rating of OCBC, we see the subsequent moves as key - i.e (1) If OCBC successfully delists GEH and acquires 100% ownership of GEH, what would be the next steps it will take to achieve higher value creation for GEH to uplift profitability for the group? We would look for OCBC's view on: i) capital optimization of GEH within OCBC group, given GEH S\$3.6bn excess capital sitting on balance sheet as of 2024; ii) harnessing of synergies between OCBC Bank and Bank of Singapore and GEH; iii) strategy to improve growth and profitability at GEH. (2) If OCBC is not able to fully acquire 100% of GEH, we would still watch for OCBC's initiatives if they are able to do (ii) and (iii) noted above.

Details of the proposals:

1. Delisting resolution: Offer price of S\$30.15 to minority shareholder of GEH, implying 0.8X 2024 P/EV (vs. 1.3X P/EV of AIA and 0.7X of Prudential and 0.3X-0.7X of other Asia lifers¹) and an uplift of 17.8% from last offer. Currently,

¹ Other Asia lifers include Dai-ichi Life, T&D, Japan Post, Thai Life, Bangkok Life

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OCBC owns 93.7% of GEH, and acquiring the remaining 6.3% would cost S\$896mn. By our estimate, OCBC excess capital as of 1Q25 would be lowered to S\$583mn post the acquisition, excluding the committed S\$2.5bn capital return plans. It is worth noting that the delisting would require at least 75% approval from minority shareholders. If the delisting is not approved, all acceptances of the exit offer will be returned, and therefore OCBC will not further increase shareholding in GEH and no further capital will be consumed. See more details in [Exhibit 2](#).

2. Resumption of trading solution: If the delisting resolution is not approved, GEH would undertake a proposed bonus issue of bonus ordinary shares and new class C non-voting share to facilitate GEH's resumption of trading. OCBC will only receive class C non-voting shares to lower its ordinary shares shareholding percentage in GEH to below 90% to meet SGX free float requirements, while its ownership in all shares would be unchanged at 93.7%, with respect to dividends and distribution.

Exhibit 1: Summary of conditional offer

	2024 May	2025 Jun
Offer price (S\$)	25.60	30.15
P/EV (X)	0.7	0.8
P/BV (X)	1.5	1.6
P/E (X)	15.6	14.3
OCBC shareholding	88.44%	93.72%
OCBC shareholding	418,586,759	443,602,605
Total number of shares	473,319,069	473,319,069
EV per share	36.59	38.08
BVPS	16.66	18.35
EPS	1.64	2.10
Estimated total acquisition cost for 100% ownership(S\$ mn)	1,401	1,536
Amount paid with 2024 May GO	640	640
Additional capital needed		896

S\$ mn	2025 Jun
Excess capital of OCBC at 1Q25	4,046
Additional capital needed for GEH acquisiton	896
Buyback announced	1,100
Special dividend	1,467
Remaining OCBC excess capital	583

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Potential scenarios of proposed transactions

Scenarios	
If 90%-100% of GEH minority shareholders accept the exit offer	- Under this circumstance, OCBC can fully acquire GEH and delist it from SGX. - OCBC intends to exercise its rights of compulsory acquisition if it is entitled the right when not less than 90% of minority shareholders accept the exit offer. - If 90% of GEH minority shareholders accept the offer before EGM, the EGM must still proceed for shareholders to vote on the delisting resolution.
If 75%-90% of GEH minority shareholders accept the exit offer and vote for delisting	- Under this circumstance, GEH can be delisted from SGX. - Shareholders who choose not to accept the exit offer will continue to hold shares in GEH, which will become an unlisted company following the delisting.
If less than 75% of GEH minority shareholders accept the exit offer and vote against delisting	- Under this circumstance, delisting of GEH is not approved, and all acceptances of the exit offer will be returned. - OCBC will vote in favour of resumption of GEH trading, with bonus share and Class C non-voting share issuance to enable GEH to meet SGX free-float requirement, with dilution to OCBC voting rights in GEH, but no change to equity interest. - OCBC has no intention of making another GO to GEH in the foreseeable future if trading is resumed.

Source: Company data

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp.

We are Buy rated on OCBC with a 12-month target price of S\$19.7 (based on a two-stage DDM). Key risks include: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected Fed cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.

OCBC.SI	12m Price Target: S\$19.70	Price: S\$16.28	Upside: 21.0%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: S\$73.0bn / \$56.8bn 3m ADTV: S\$123.5mn / \$93.6mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3	Net inc. (\$ mn)	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	EPS (\$)	7,587.0	7,055.8	7,363.2	7,910.8
	EPS growth (%)	1.68	1.57	1.64	1.77
	P/E (X)	8.1	(6.3)	4.4	7.4
	P/B (X)	8.6	10.3	9.9	9.2
	ROA (%)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
	ROE (%)	1.3	1.1	1.1	1.1
	Price/PPOP (X)	13.7	12.1	12.2	12.4
	Price/PPOP (X)	8.4	8.8	8.5	8.0
	Dividend yield (%)	7.0	5.8	6.1	6.6

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 6 Jun 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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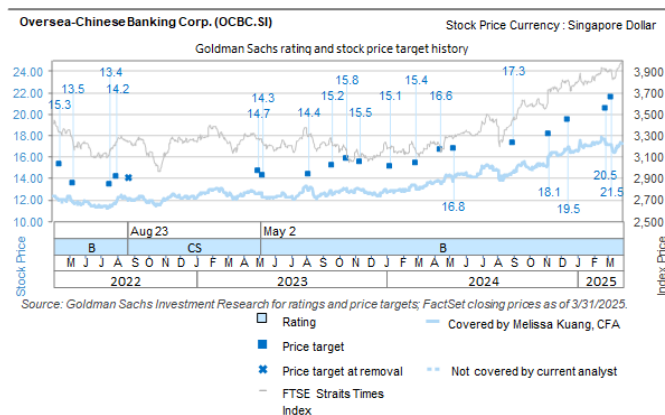
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